Smooth reads your classes, then keeps up.

A walkthrough of what the app does under the proposed design, from the day a class connects to a normal Tuesday in week ten. Written for evaluating the idea, not for students.

In one paragraph. When a class connects, Smooth reads everything that class has published, once and carefully, and writes itself a set of notes about how the class works and what is coming for the whole semester. From then on, every hour, it looks for anything new (an announcement, an Ed post, an edited page, a new assignment) and reads it against those notes. Anything that changes your work becomes a small, checked "fact" attached to the card it affects: cancelled, moved, narrowed, new. Your list is still a list that code maintains. The AI never rewrites it. It only tells the code what changed, and shows you where it read that.

The picture

DAY 1	**Everything the class has** syllabus, every module and item, every page, assignment descriptions, home page	**The first read** one careful pass by the best model, once per class, shared by classmates	**Semester map** week structure, rhythms, every item with a stated or inferred date, rules, unknowns	**Your list** real cards plus "expected" cards months out, each with a source
EVERY HOUR	**Anything new** an announcement, an Ed post, an edited page, a new or changed assignment	**Read against the map** the model sees the post, the map and your class's item list side by side	**Facts** cancel · move · narrow · new task · note · needs a look, each with a quote	**Your cards change** tagged, dated, undoable; the megaphone shows what changed

Day 1: a class connects

You sign in to Canvas as today. For each class, Smooth pulls the syllabus, every module with every item inside it in order (including the subheaders professors use as week labels), every page, every assignment with its description, and the home page. That already happens today. What is new is the **first read**.

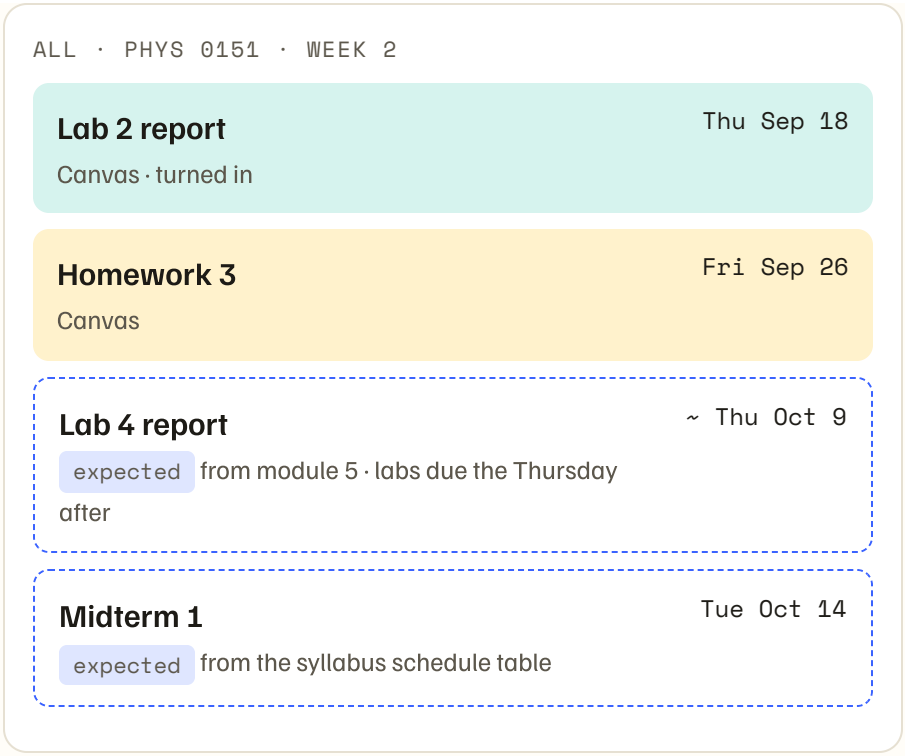
The first read is one long, careful pass by the strongest model we use anywhere in the app. It runs once per class, on the server, and every student in that class shares the result. It produces the **semester map**: Smooth's notes on the class. The map records

- which module is which week, and which calendar dates that means, using the class's meeting days
- the rhythm of the class: "quiz every Friday", "prelab is due before each lab", "readings are listed per week and never dated"
- every piece of work it found, with the date Canvas states, or the date it worked out from position, and a note of which it is
- the standing rules: late policy, lowest grade dropped, what counts for what
- exam dates and milestones that exist only in the syllabus or on a schedule page
- a list of things it could not pin down, which get flagged rather than guessed

The map is re-read only when the modules or the syllabus change, which Smooth detects by comparing content hashes, something it already does for every document.

What you see on day 1

The **todo** and **all** views look like today's, with one addition. Work that the map found but that Canvas has not published yet shows up in **all** as an *expected* card: dashed outline, "expected" instead of a firm date, and the source on the card. You can see a lab in week 11 in week 2. When Canvas later publishes the real assignment, the expected card merges into it. You never get two.



Every hour: something new arrives

The hourly sync already fetches new announcements, Ed posts and page edits. Under the new design, each new document is read **against the map**: the model sees the post, the class's notes, the list of that class's current items (titles, ids, dates), and the post's own date and weekday, all at once. That is what lets it understand "the usual quiz is pushed to Monday": it already knows there is a usual quiz and which card that is.

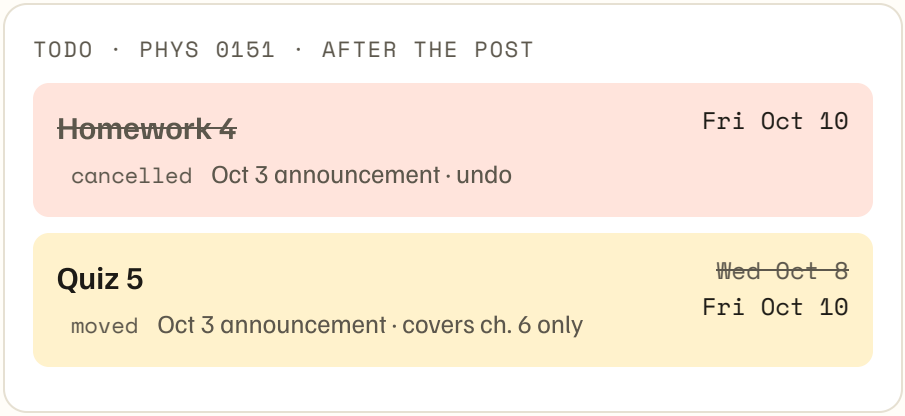
The model does not answer with prose. It answers with **facts**, each naming the card it affects by id and quoting the sentence it read:

FACT	WHAT IT DOES TO YOUR LIST
`cancel`	The card leaves todo and is tagged "cancelled · Oct 3 announcement" in all and prev.
`move`	The card shows the new date with the old one struck through.
`narrow`	A note on the card: "only problems 1 to 4", "submit on Gradescope".
`new task`	A new card: "read 3.1 to 3.3 before Tuesday's lecture", with the post as its source.
`note`	"Quiz covers chapters 5 and 6", attached to the quiz card.
`needs a look`	The post was ambiguous. Nothing changes; it is shown to you in the megaphone to decide.

Before any fact touches your list, code checks it: the quoted sentence must really be in the post, the card id must really exist, the date must be sane. A fact that fails any check is thrown away. That is the guard against the AI inventing work.

Example

On Friday Oct 3 the professor posts: *"Given the exam next week, HW4 is cancelled. The Wednesday quiz moves to Friday and will only cover chapter 6."*



Tap "Oct 3 announcement" and the post opens. Tap "undo" and HW4 is back, and Smooth remembers you overruled it.

What a card knows about itself

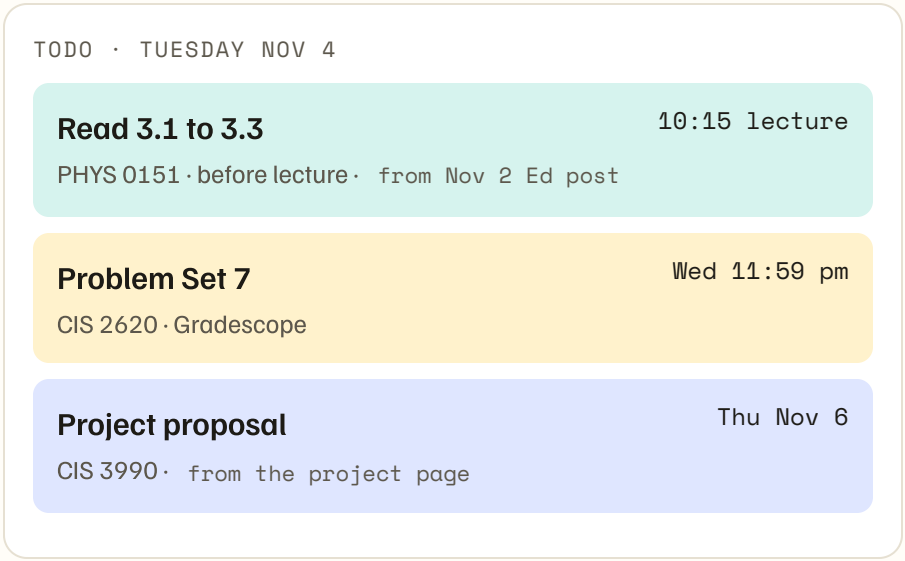
Announcements stop being a separate list of tasks. They become part of the card's history. Open any card and it shows where it came from and everything that has changed it, newest first:

- "from Canvas · published Sep 20"
- "moved to Fri Oct 10 · Oct 3 announcement"
- "only chapter 6 · Oct 3 announcement"
- "room changed to DRL A4 · Oct 9 Ed post"

The same card can be fed by several sources at once. The Canvas assignment, the module item that points at it, the Gradescope assignment where you submit it, and the expected card from the map are all one card, because Smooth matches them by their real ids first, by title and date closeness second, and lets the model pick only from candidates it was shown. Two different Canvas ids are never merged, so "Lab 3" and "Lab 3 report" stay two cards.

Your day

Once facts are applied, "today" needs no AI at all. The todo view is: anything overdue, anything due in the next two days, preparation tasks for tomorrow's lecture, and your class meetings for the day, minus any a post cancelled. It is computed, so it is the same every time you open it.



The megaphone becomes "what changed"

Today the megaphone lists recent posts. Under the new design it lists **facts**, grouped by the card they changed, so a glance tells you what is different since you last looked: "HW4 cancelled", "Quiz 5 moved to Friday", "new reading before Tuesday". Posts that changed nothing are listed below, as today. At the top, if there are any, the "needs a look" items: posts the model would not act on alone, with the sentence it was unsure about, and two buttons.

Rules the app never breaks

1. **Nothing you did is ever lost.** A fact can hide or retag a card. It cannot delete one, and it cannot mark one done.
2. **Your own edits win.** If you moved a date or marked something done, no fact overrides it.
3. **Canvas's own data beats a post.** If the assignment's date already changed in Canvas, the post is confirmation, not news.

4. **Newer beats older.** A correction post supersedes the one before it, by date.
5. **Every fact has a quote.** No quote in the source, no fact.
6. **Unsure means ask, not guess.** Ambiguity becomes "needs a look", never a silent change.
7. **Everything is undoable** and one tap from the post it came from.

A week in week ten

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT YOU SEE
Mon 9 am	CIS 2620 staff Ed post: "No recitation this week. PS7 due Wednesday as planned."	Wednesday recitation gone from Wednesday's meetings. PS7 untouched (it already said Wednesday).
Mon 2 pm	PHYS 0151 schedule page edited: Lab 7 moved a week later.	The expected Lab 7 card slides to the new week, tagged "moved · schedule page, Nov 3".
Tue 8 am	Canvas publishes the real "Lab 6 report" assignment.	The expected card becomes a real card. Same card, firm date now.
Tue 6 pm	Professor's announcement: "I'll return the midterms Thursday."	Nothing. The model is told the professor's own actions are not your tasks. The post sits in the megaphone's "other posts".
Wed 11 am	Ed post: "If you did the optional project you can skip HW8."	`needs a look` in the megaphone: "Skip HW8?" with the quote, and Yes / No.
Thu 9 pm	Announcement: "Typo in Tuesday's post: the reading is 3.1 to 3.4, not 3.3."	The reading card's note updates; the older fact is superseded, history shows both.
Fri	Nothing new.	Nothing runs. Nothing costs anything.

What it still does not do

- Hear anything said only in lecture, by email, or on Slack.
- Read private Ed threads.
- Keep up while the Canvas session is dead. Facts simply go stale until sign-in works again; nothing is invented to fill the gap.

- Decide anything ambiguous on its own.

Companion to "Could Smooth build your day instead of copying Canvas?" (the research and costs) and `docs/DAY_PLANNER_RESEARCH_2026-11-03.md` on the v8 branch. Nothing here is built; the sample cards are illustrations.